

"Everything we know about clothing from the Neolithic age in Europe is from him. There is nothing to compare. He is alone."

—Dr. Markus Egg, Archaeologist (b. 1954)

ÖTZI AMBUSHED

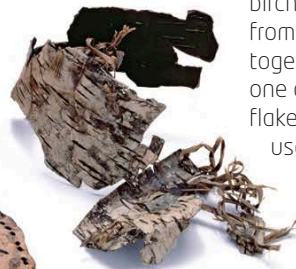
It's early summer, over 5,300 years ago. Ötzi, a hunter from a farming community in the Ötztal Alps, is scrambling up a glacier. Despite being well-prepared for the hostile terrain, it's been an exhausting few days. He's being pursued by an attacker who wounded his hand with a knife. He's already escaped once but now, as he flees higher up the mountain, he senses there might be danger around the corner. It turns out he was right.



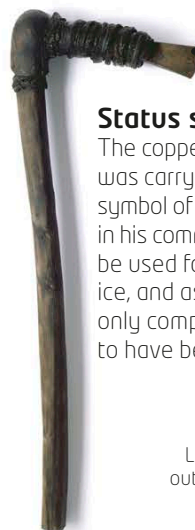
Birch-bark containers are lightweight but very strong.

Birch-bark containers

Lying close to Ötzi's body, archaeologists found two round containers made of birch bark. The containers were made from a single piece of bark and stitched together with fibers from a lime tree. Inside one of the pots, maple leaves and charcoal flakes were discovered, suggesting Ötzi used the containers to carry charcoal embers wrapped in leaves so he could start a fire quickly and easily.



The container's base was made from a round piece of birch.



The blade was bound to the handle with leather thongs.

Status symbol

The copper-headed ax that Ötzi was carrying when he died was a symbol of the high status he held in his community. The ax would be used for felling trees, cutting ice, and as a weapon. It is the only complete prehistoric ax to have been discovered.

Leather straps tied the outer and inner layers of the shoe to the sole.

Early acupuncture

Ötzi is the world's oldest known tattooed mummy. Tattoos of lines and crosses were located on his body where he would have suffered joint pain. Scientists think they were a form of pain relief.



Comfy shoes

Ötzi's shoes would have been warm and comfortable, although they would not have kept his feet dry from the rain.

The outside of the shoes were made from deerskin, with a bearskin sole. Inside, a woven-grass netting held a layer of hay in place for warmth.



7 Clothing

Well-prepared for the freezing conditions, Ötzi wears garments made from goat and sheep skin.

8 Copper Ax

Ötzi's most treasured possession is his ax, made of yew with a copper blade.

